Mock Interview Edition

Computer-Use Agents: Screenshots In, Coordinates Out, and the Cost of Avoiding an API

16 scenarios with their follow-up probes and no answers. Use it to rehearse aloud, with a partner, or against a timer, then check yourself against the Study Edition.

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HOW THIS EDITION IS ORGANIZED

Section A, round plans: 5 ready-made sessions of five scenarios each, by theme. **Section B, question sheets:** every scenario followed by all of its probes, in order, each with its own notes box. The Study Edition page that holds the answers is printed under each scenario. **Section C, score sheet:** one row per scenario to track attempts. Question numbers and part numbers are identical in the Study Edition.

THREE WAYS TO USE IT

1. With a partner. The partner reads the scenario aloud, then asks the probes one at a time, moving on only after you have answered. **2. Alone, out loud.** Cover everything below the current probe with a sheet of paper, answer aloud for about two minutes, then slide the paper down to the next probe. **3. Alone, in writing.** Jot your key points in the notes box under each probe before looking at the next one, then compare with the Study Edition page printed under the scenario.

HOW TO GRADE A PROBE

Solid: you stated the main point, gave a number or a concrete example where one was possible, and said how you would check it. **Partial:** right direction but vague, or a number without the reasoning. **Missed:** you did not reach it, or reached the wrong conclusion. The last probe of every scenario asks for the general lesson in one sentence. Suggested pacing is about 12 minutes per scenario. Reading the answer only after you have committed to your own is what makes the practice work.

A NOTE ON THE PACING, GRADING AND ROUNDS

The 12-minute pacing, the three-level grading and the round compositions are the author's suggestions for practice, not an industry standard. The scenarios are written for this document and are not taken from a real company question bank. Where a scenario quotes a figure, the Study Edition says where it comes from.

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Every line below is a link: click it to jump to that page. The outline panel of your PDF viewer lists the same entries, and the “Contents” link in every page footer brings you back here. Question numbers are the same as in the Study Edition.

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Every scenario, by part

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SECTION A

Round plans

Each round has five scenarios at about 12 minutes each, a 60-minute session. Mix and match freely. Click any scenario to jump to its question sheet; the number on the right is the page.

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03 Read the OSWorld score Evaluation 7
04 Do not conflate the two scores Evaluation 8
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11 Define action grounding Agent design 18
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SECTION B

Question sheets

Each scenario is followed by its probes in order. Indentation shows how deep the follow-up goes.

PART 1

Framing the objective and reading the benchmark

Why this agent operates a GUI rather than an API, what the three bars of success are, and how to read a low benchmark score and a coding score that does not belong to this loop.

01 GUI or direct API?

FRAMING

SCENARIO

A product manager says the agent should just call each app's API, so why build something that stares at a screen and moves a mouse. Explain the objective and why operating the GUI is the design, not an oversight.

OPENING PROBE

What is the objective?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What is 'general computer skills'?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

Why not just call the API?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Is this the better choice in general?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 6

02 Three bars of success

EVALUATION

SCENARIO

An engineer wants one pass or fail number for the agent. Explain the three different bars and why per-action success is not the same as task success.

OPENING PROBE

What is the real-world bar?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What is the benchmark bar?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is per-action grounding?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Why is grounding not the same as task success?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 7

03 Read the OSWorld score

EVALUATION

SCENARIO

A slide quotes: Claude 3.5 Sonnet scored 14.9% on OSWorld screenshot-only, against 7.8% for the next best, and 22.0% with more steps. A reader takes this as near-solved. Say what the number means.

OPENING PROBE

What does OSWorld grade?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What are the confirmed figures?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

How low is that, really?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

What does the gap to 22.0% show?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 8

04 Do not conflate the two scores

EVALUATION

SCENARIO

The same announcement says computer use 'improves performance on SWE-bench Verified from 33.4% to 49.0%'. A teammate cites this as proof the screenshot loop works well. Explain why that is the wrong reading.

OPENING PROBE

What does SWE-bench Verified measure?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What does OSWorld measure?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

Why not conflate them?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

What should you cite for the loop?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 9

PART 2

Sizing the loop and the cost of avoiding an API

Costing one screenshot task, timing its latency chain, comparing it to a direct API, and naming the term the estimate depends on and the one that cannot be cached.

05 Cost one screenshot task

SIZING

SCENARIO

A moderate task takes 24 round-trips, each sending a 1,400-token screenshot plus 800 tokens of history and returning 150 output tokens, at 3 dollars per million input and 15 per million output. Estimate the token cost.

OPENING PROBE

What is the input per round-trip?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What are the totals?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is the cost?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Is this a floor or a ceiling?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 10

06 Time the latency chain

SIZING

SCENARIO

Each round-trip is screenshot capture 100 ms, encode and upload 150 ms, model inference 2,000 ms, action execution 50 ms, and a settle delay of 2.0 seconds. Estimate per-step and total latency for a 24-step task.

OPENING PROBE

What is per-step latency?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

Where does the settle delay come from?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is the task total?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Why does that matter for serving?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 11

07 Compare to a direct API

SIZING

SCENARIO

The same logical task through an API might take 2 structured calls at 300 input and 50 output tokens each, finishing in 1 to 2 seconds. Give the cost and latency ratios, then say when the GUI loop is still the right choice.

OPENING PROBE

What is the direct-API cost?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What are the ratios?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

When is the loop still right?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

What does this say about defaults?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 12

08 Sensitivity and what cannot be cached

SIZING

SCENARIO

Someone proposes cutting cost by caching the prompt, and separately asks which assumption to measure first. Say which input the estimate is most sensitive to, and what caching can and cannot recover.

OPENING PROBE

Which input is most sensitive?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What if inference doubles?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is cacheable?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

What is not cacheable?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 13

PART 3

Perception, grounding, and the agent core

What the agent actually sees, the coordinate mapping that must be right, the grounding failure mode a tool call never has, and why observing each step is load-bearing.

09 What does the agent perceive?

DATA

SCENARIO

A colleague assumes the agent receives the page's buttons and fields as structured data, like a normal tool call. Explain what it actually perceives and why that forces a new concept.

OPENING PROBE

What is the input each step?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

How does that differ from other agents?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What does it have to do with those pixels?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Why does that force a new concept?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 14

10 Review the click handler

CODE REVIEW

SCENARIO

On most screens the agent clicks fine, but on high-DPI laptops every click lands up and to the left of the target, by a consistent amount. The handler below executes the model's coordinate. Find the fault and fix it.

```
def do_click(model_coord, display):
    # model_coord came back from the model, in the scaled frame (e.g. XGA 1024x768)
    x, y = model_coord
    display.click(x, y)   # clicked straight onto the physical screen
```

OPENING PROBE

Which frame does the model use?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What does the handler do wrong?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is the fix?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

How would you catch it?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 15

11 Define action grounding

AGENT DESIGN

SCENARIO

An interviewer asks what action grounding is, why it is specific to this architecture, and what makes some elements harder than others. Give the definition and a mitigation.

OPENING PROBE

What is action grounding?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What is a grounding error?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

Why is it specific to this architecture?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Which elements are hard, and what helps?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 16

12 Why observe every step?

AGENT DESIGN

SCENARIO

Someone proposes having the model plan all 24 actions up front and execute them without fresh screenshots, to save time. At 95% per-action grounding accuracy, estimate the clean-run chance and say what it implies.

OPENING PROBE

What is the formula?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What is the value?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

Why does a fresh screenshot help?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Is this Anthropic's real number?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 17

PART 4

Serving, security, and operating the agent

Why a short task still cannot be one request, why prompt injection is unusually acute here, monitoring the grounding failure mode, and the tension in a cautious rollout.

13 Why not one synchronous request?

SERVING

SCENARIO

A colleague wants the submit call to hold the connection open until the task finishes. Given a 24-step task takes about 103 seconds, explain why that fails and what the shape should be.

OPENING PROBE

What is the timeout problem?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What is the submit shape?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

Where does the loop run?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

How does the caller follow it?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 18

14 Why is prompt injection acute here?

SECURITY

SCENARIO

A reviewer treats prompt injection as a generic risk handled by a system prompt. Explain why this architecture is an unusually acute case and what bounds the damage.

OPENING PROBE

What is the model's input each step?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

Why is a system prompt not enough?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is the blast radius?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

What bounds it?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 19

15 Monitor the grounding failure mode

OPERATIONS

SCENARIO

A task fails OSWorld-style grading, and the team cannot tell whether the plan was wrong or a click missed. Design the monitoring that tells them apart, and where each failure routes.

OPENING PROBE

What does a failing grade not tell you?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

What should you log?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is that metric like?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

Where does each failure route?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 20

16 The cautious-rollout tension

OPERATIONS

SCENARIO

A lead wants to deploy the agent broadly and audit every task. Explain the deployment gate Anthropic recommends, the audit trade-off, and the tension the safe path creates.

OPENING PROBE

What gate does Anthropic recommend?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 1 OF 4

Full audit or sampled?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 2 OF 4

What is the tension?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 3 OF 4

How do you resolve it?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

FOLLOW-UP 4 OF 4

Reframe it: what is the general lesson, in one sentence?

YOUR NOTES: key points you would make

Answers: Study Edition, page 21

SECTION C

Score sheet

Write how many probes were solid out of the total, per attempt. Revisit anything under half after reading the Study Edition's concepts box.

No.	Scenario	Probes	Attempt 1	Attempt 2	Attempt 3
01	GUI or direct API?	5			
02	Three bars of success	5			
03	Read the OSWorld score	5			
04	Do not conflate the two scores	5			
05	Cost one screenshot task	5			
06	Time the latency chain	5			
07	Compare to a direct API	5			
08	Sensitivity and what cannot be cached	5			
09	What does the agent perceive?	5			
10	Review the click handler	5			
11	Define action grounding	5			
12	Why observe every step?	5			
13	Why not one synchronous request?	5			
14	Why is prompt injection acute here?	5			
15	Monitor the grounding failure mode	5			
16	The cautious-rollout tension	5			